GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas

Energizing India's Growth Story

Confidential and Proprietory

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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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SHRI HARDEEP SINGH PURI



HONORABLE MINISTER,

MINISTRY OF PETROLEUM AND NATURAL GAS

MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

The petroleum and natural gas sector continues to be a cornerstone of India's energy security, industrial development, transportation, and economic growth. As the nation moves towards a diversified and sustainable energy future, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas plays a strategic role in ensuring reliable energy access, expanding infrastructure, promoting cleaner fuels, strengthening domestic production, and encouraging innovation across the energy value chain.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes the sector's critical contribution to national development and remains committed to supporting the Ministry through policy advocacy, investment facilitation, technology partnerships, industry collaboration, startup engagement, and innovation-driven initiatives. By fostering cooperation between government, industry, research institutions, financial organizations, and entrepreneurs, CCI India seeks to contribute towards building a resilient and globally competitive energy ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, policy reforms, infrastructure initiatives, investment opportunities, and emerging technologies across exploration, refining, natural gas distribution, petrochemicals, green fuels, hydrogen, carbon management, and energy transition. It also identifies collaborative pathways that can accelerate technological advancement, sustainability, and industrial competitiveness.

The publication is intended to serve as a strategic reference for policymakers, energy companies, investors, technology providers, researchers, academic institutions, financial organizations, startups, and development agencies seeking to contribute to India's evolving energy landscape. Through collaborative engagement and knowledge sharing, it aims to promote innovation, strengthen energy infrastructure, attract investments, and enhance long-term energy security.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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Preface

Energy is the foundational input of national development. India's trajectory toward becoming a USD 7 trillion economy by 2030, and a fully developed nation under the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision, rests on the availability of secure, affordable, and increasingly sustainable energy. The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG) occupies a position of singular strategic importance within this trajectory: it governs the exploration, production, refining, distribution, and pricing of hydrocarbons that power approximately half of India's primary energy consumption, while simultaneously stewarding the nation's transition toward natural gas, biofuels, and green hydrogen as the energy mix evolves.

India's energy economy is at an inflection point. Crude oil import dependence has risen to nearly 89 percent even as the government pursues an aggressive domestic exploration agenda; the ethanol blending programme has achieved its 20 percent target five years ahead of schedule; the National Gas Grid is approaching pan-India coverage; and the green hydrogen ecosystem is transitioning from pilot to early commercial scale. Each of these movements creates distinct windows for industry engagement, capital deployment, technology partnership, and policy collaboration.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared to support a structured, evidence-based dialogue between the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and India's industry and investment ecosystem. It is intended to move beyond descriptive commentary and instead provide a strategic diagnostic: where the Ministry's institutional architecture creates points of leverage for private and industry participation, where execution gaps persist despite sound policy design, and where new collaboration architectures can convert national ambition into measurable outcomes.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India) envisions itself as a long-term strategic partner to the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas functioning simultaneously as an industry facilitator that channels private sector capability toward national energy priorities, as a policy advocate that surfaces ground-level implementation realities to policymakers, as an investment promotion partner that connects domestic and international capital to bankable opportunities in the hydrocarbon and clean-fuel value chain, and as a knowledge and capacity-building institution that strengthens the human and institutional capital underpinning India's energy transition.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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Section 1: Introduction to the Ministry

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG) is the apex Union Government institution responsible for the exploration, production, refining, distribution, marketing, import, export, conservation, and pricing of petroleum, natural gas, petroleum products, and liquefied natural gas in India. Established in 1963 through the reorganisation of earlier oil-sector administrative arrangements, the Ministry has evolved over six decades from an instrument of post-independence resource nationalism into a sophisticated regulatory and policy institution that balances energy security, market liberalisation, fiscal management, and climate commitments simultaneously.

Constitutional and Legal Mandate

The Ministry's mandate derives from the Union List under the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, which assigns regulation of oilfields and mineral oil resources, and the development of petroleum and petroleum products, to the Union Government. This constitutional allocation reflects the recognition that hydrocarbon resources given their cross-state distribution, strategic character, and linkage to national fiscal and foreign exchange stability require centralised stewardship rather than fragmented state-level administration. The Ministry operationalises this mandate through a combination of statutory instruments, the most significant being the Oilfields (Regulation and Development) Act, 1948 (substantially amended in 2025 to extend licence tenures and enable unified licensing of multiple hydrocarbon types), the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board Act, 2006, and the Petroleum Act, 1934 governing the import, transport, and storage of petroleum.

- **Sovereign Resource Trusteeship:** The Ministry administers India's hydrocarbon resources as a sovereign trustee, awarding exploration and production rights through transparent licensing mechanisms such as the Hydrocarbon Exploration and Licensing Policy (HELP) while retaining ownership of subsurface resources on behalf of the nation. This trusteeship role is significant for CCI India because it positions the Ministry as the gatekeeper for upstream investment access; any industry engagement strategy for the exploration and production segment must work through the Ministry's licensing architecture rather than around it, making structured institutional dialogue a precondition for capital deployment in this segment.

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